

Kill your darlings: Curate Your Images (Week 3)

Track:	General AI Fluency	Phase:	Foundations
Type:	Assignment Deliverable	Workload:	2 Hours

1. Content Map & The Keepers (Final Selected Image Set)

Every image mapped strictly against sitemap sections, prioritizing real engineering captures over generated stand-ins:

- 1. Hero Section & Main Proof • Real Native Capture**

Selected Asset: High-resolution, clean screenshot of the live application interface and terminal execution window.

Format & Crop: 16:9 desktop container crop focused tightly on operational logic and real system inputs.

Why Real Over AI: A real screenshot provides undeniable proof that the software is deployed and functional, something an AI-generated mockup can never prove to a technical reviewer.
- 2. Case Study Architectural Breakdown • Real Design Capture**

Selected Asset: Direct export of system architecture diagrams and logic flowcharts from Figma.

Format & Crop: Crisp vector PNG showing component boundaries, API pathways, and data routing.

Why Real Over AI: Demonstrates real engineering judgment and architectural decision-making rather than cosmetic fluff.
- 3. About Section • Real Photograph**

Selected Asset: Plain personal headshot taken in natural light with a clean background.

Format & Crop: Square 1:1 portrait crop without beauty filters or artificial styling.

Why Real Over AI: Trust requires an authentic human face. AI avatars look artificial and instantly hurt technical credibility in a hiring review.

2. Connective Tissue: Consistent AI Vector Set

AI generation was strictly confined to supporting visual anchors and icon assets, locked into a single aesthetic:

Visual Ruleset: Flat vector line art, consistent 2px stroke, minimal geometry, isolated on transparent or slate (#0F172A) background to match the Week 3 Identity Kit.

Locked Generation Prompt:

"Flat minimalist line icon for [TOPIC], uniform 2px vector stroke, clean geometry, isolated object centered, slate monochrome palette with subtle blue accent, UI asset style, no 3D gradients, no photorealism, no busy details"

How Style Was Held Steady: Generation seeds and aspect ratios were locked. For different utilities (Analytics, Terminal, Security), only the subject noun was changed while preserving exact negative prompts and style tokens.

3. Where I Chose Real Captures Over AI (Decision Calls)

Portfolio Section	Source Type	Operational Justification
Hero & Case Studies	Real Native Captures	AI mockups hallucinate impossible UI elements and fake data. Real screenshots prove code execution and system reality.
About / Profile	Real Headshot Photo	Human evaluators look for genuine peer presence. AI avatars create an immediate sense of artificial detachment.
Navigation & Badges	Controlled AI Vector	Used solely as lightweight visual scaffolding that supports the layout without competing for user attention.

4. Graded Discernment Note: Curated Rejection

Rejected Asset: Generated 3D Isometric Server Room Visual

Why It Was Scrapped: I initially generated a high-detail 3D render of glowing server racks for the hero background. While visually striking in isolation, it completely overpowered the real application screenshots sitting above it. The high contrast and heavy neon lighting fought with the case study text and felt like a generic stock template. I rejected it in favor of a clean, subtle vector grid that keeps the focus entirely on the actual software screenshots.